

MUSIC



Musical sounds can be made with your voice or by playing an instrument. The first instruments were played more than 42,000 years ago—people blew into shells and hollow mammoth bones! Today’s instruments are more complicated. The sounds they make can be high or low: this is known as the pitch of the note. The way these sounds are arranged is called the tune. Rhythm is the pattern of long and short notes. A skillful musician can make the same tune sound slow and sleepy, or loud and jazzy.



Beat the clock?

A metronome can tick at different speeds. Musicians listen to it to make sure they are playing at the right speed. This is called keeping the beat.

Music groups



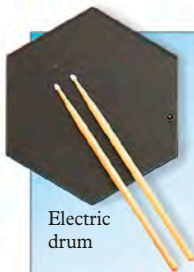
Jazz band



Pop group



String quartet



Electric drum



Electric saxophone



Deeper notes are written on lower lines or in lower spaces.

Wired for sound

Electronic instruments are actually almost silent! When you twang the steel strings on an electric guitar, they vibrate. This movement is changed into tiny electrical signals by pickups beneath the strings. These signals are then increased by an amplifier and finally turned into sounds by an amplifier.

Electric guitar



A pickup

Note it

Music is written down in a special language. Instead of words, there are notes. These are the notes for “Here Comes the Bride.”



This number tells you there are four beats in each bar.

The way a note looks indicates how long it lasts.

Notes are named after letters. This one in the second space up is A.

